

How Mandarin finds and names your music

Adding, scanning, identifying and matching, in plain words.

1 Adding music

- The folder you picked when you installed Mandarin is your first music folder.
- To add more (a second folder, or an external drive), open **Settings → Music Folders** and pick them from the list.
- Mandarin only **reads** your music. It never changes, moves or renames your files.

2 Scanning: reading what you have

- Mandarin reads the information already inside each music file: artist, album, title, track number, year and the cover picture.
- It treats **each folder as one album**. Folders called *Disc 1 / CD2* inside an album's folder are joined into one album.
- Files with no information inside them get names from their folder and file names, e.g. *Artist / Album (1993) / 01 - Song*.
- New or deleted music usually shows up by itself. If it doesn't, it shows up at the next full check, every 6 hours. To check straight away, open the side menu (≡) and tap **Rescan library**.

3 Identifying: getting the names right

This is for albums with wrong or missing names, like "Various Artists" on a normal album, or tracks called "Track 01". It's controlled in **Settings → Library Scanner**. It's on by default, and it only runs **at night (1am-6am)** unless you change that.

For each album it tries, in this order:

1. **Codes in the files**. Many files carry a barcode, catalogue number or MusicBrainz code, which is the surest way to find the exact album.
2. **MusicBrainz**, a free public music database. Mandarin searches it using the album's track count and the length of every track. Twelve tracks that match a release's lengths to the second are almost certainly that album.
3. **Apple's iTunes catalogue**, as a second opinion for albums MusicBrainz doesn't know.

4 Matching: what happens to the result

95% sure or better The correct names are used straight away. Each change has an **Undo** button.

Close but not sure It's listed for you to tap **Accept** or **Reject**.

Nothing close It's listed as unidentified. Tap the album, then **⋮ → Edit album** to name it yourself, or type the barcode from the case.

- Albums you've edited yourself are never changed by the scanner.
- The corrected names are kept in Mandarin's own records. Your files stay exactly as they were.

Good to know

- **It's slow on purpose**. MusicBrainz allows only about one question a second, so a large collection can take several nights to work through.
- **The optional MusicBrainz pack** (Settings → Library Scanner, about 2 GB) is a downloaded copy of every album in MusicBrainz that has a barcode. Albums with barcodes are then matched from the copy, which is quicker and still works when the MusicBrainz website is down.
- **Volume levels**: Library Scanner also has **Measure ReplayGain**. It's off by default. Switched on, it works out how loud each track is, for even volume between tracks.